

Did a civilisation exist on Earth before humans?



Listen to the full episode here: <https://bbc.in/3KGZuXF>

1. **Look at the cover image and title of the episode. What do you think this episode is about? What do you know about this topic already? What vocabulary do you associate with this topic?**
2. **Now listen to the first two minutes of the episode.**
 - What do the presenters say the episode is about?
 - What is this week's question? What do you think the answer is?
3. **Now listen to the whole episode. As you listen, write down the six items of vocabulary. What do they mean?**

- a) Word/phrase: _____
It means: _____.
- b) Word/phrase: _____
It means: _____.
- c) Word/phrase: _____
It means: _____.
- d) Word/phrase: _____
It means: _____.
- e) Word/phrase: _____
It means: _____.
- f) Word/phrase: _____
It means: _____.

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4. What did you learn that was surprising or new in this episode?

5. Answer the quiz questions. Listen again or use the transcript to help you.

1. What is the Silurian hypothesis?
 - a) the idea that the Earth is flat
 - b) the idea that life exists on other planets
 - c) the idea that advanced civilisations have existed before on Earth
2. Which phrase describes someone who looks very shocked and surprised?
 - a) their jaw broke
 - b) their jaw dropped
 - c) their jaw locked
3. What is a consensus?
 - a) a general agreement
 - b) a population survey
 - c) a sensitive person
4. "I left my bike outside the shop for 30 seconds and someone stole it! It was gone in ____."
 - a) the blink of an eye
 - b) the wink of an eye
 - c) the flap of an ear
5. Which phrase means 'a very small amount'?
 - a) a tiny fraction
 - b) a tiny friction
 - c) a tiny fiction
6. What are 'the remains of prehistoric plants or animals that have been preserved in rock'?
 - a) artefacts
 - b) fossils
 - c) hypothesis

6 Minute English worksheet

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6. Write your own sentences using the vocabulary.

7. Answer the following questions.

- What are three things you have learnt from this episode?
- How does this topic make you feel?
- Give three examples relevant to your life using the vocabulary.

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Answers

3.

- a. (someone's) jaw dropped – (idiom) used to say someone looks very shocked and surprised
- b. hypothesis – idea that is suggested to explain something and which can then be tested to find out if it's correct
- c. fossil – remains of a prehistoric plant or animal that have been preserved in rock for a very long time
- d. tiny fraction – very small amount
- e. the blink of an eye – (idiom) a very short period of time
- f. consensus – general agreement

5. 1c, 2b, 3a, 4a, 5a, 6b

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6 Minute English worksheet

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Teacher's notes

This worksheet is standardised so that you can amend and use it as appropriate with your classes.

Some topics may be difficult for learners, especially those which could be upsetting or cause offence. Please be mindful of this when using this worksheet and adapt it as necessary.

Extension activities

- Role-play an interview with an 'interviewer' and an 'expert' on this topic.
- Write a short story or article using the vocabulary from this episode.
- Read original articles on this topic.
- For homework: If it is available in your country, download and listen to the original podcast these extracts were taken from.